BIRGIT BADER

TECHNICAL COMMUNICATION

Helping growing tech companies scale knowledge, communication, and developer experience.

CONTACT

Hamburg, Germany
+49 17654098945
bader-birgit@web.de
birgitbader.com
linkedin.com/in/birgit-b-838503207/

CORE COMPETENCIES

Technical Communication

- Technical Writing
- Docs as Code
- Content Strategy
- Information Architecture
- Localization

Knowledge & Enablement

- Knowledge Management
- Content Governance
- Internal Enablement
- AI-assisted Content
- Information Design

Developer Experience

- API Documentation
- Developer Portals
- Developer Relations
- Onboarding

Product & Process

- Product Ownership
- Process Design
- Stakeholder Management
- Target Group Analysis & User Research
- Problem Solving

Leadership & Collaboration

- Lateral Leadership
- Organizational Alignment
- Mentoring
- Facilitation & Workshops
- Change & Adoption

PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

For more than 15 years, I've worked in the space between teams, where different disciplines, priorities, and perspectives meet. That's where communication either creates friction or momentum.

I connect engineering, product, UX, business, and customer-facing teams to create the shared understanding that helps organizations make better decisions, move faster, and scale with confidence.

I spent 6 years in wind energy. Now I want to bring everything I've learned since then back to the energy transition.

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

TECHNICAL WRITING EXPERT | OTTO | Mar 2025 – present

- Lead a team of 6 technical writers laterally, enabling 100+ engineering teams.
- Built communication practices that reduced friction across engineering and kept teams aligned as the organization grew.
- Build knowledge structures that work for both humans and AI.
- Partner with engineering, product, and leadership on developer experience, knowledge sharing, and AI initiatives.
- Share expertise both internally and externally through talks and at conferences.
- Mentor colleagues and promote best practices in technical communication.

SENIOR TECHNICAL WRITER | OTTO | Oct 2022 – Feb 2025

- Established the technical writer role within the company and built the team.
- Built a knowledge ecosystem that made information consistent, easy to find, and shared across teams.
- Grew communities around technical communication and knowledge sharing.
- Improved content discoverability and usability for developer audiences.
- Made APIs and internal products easier to understand and adopt for developers.

SENIOR PRODUCT MANAGER / API PRODUCT OWNER | OTTO | Nov 2020 – Sept 2022

- Owned vision and roadmap for OTTO's Consumer API portal.
- Grounded priorities in user research with developers.
- Worked with engineering and product to improve API quality and consistency.
- Established review processes and standards that raised the bar for API quality.

SENIOR PROCESS MANAGER | OTTO | Feb 2020 – Oct 2020

- Pioneered technical writing at OTTO: identified audiences and built buy-in.
- Introduced API guidelines and built an internal API community.
- Raised awareness for high-quality, usable APIs through hands-on collaboration with product, engineering, and leadership.

TOOLS & TECHNOLOGIES

Jira • Confluence • GitHub • VS Code

Markdown • OpenAPI • Postman • REST APIs

Miro • Zendesk • Google Analytics

Schema ST4 • Phrase • MS Office

AI-assisted tools

LANGUAGES

German: Native

English: Fluent

Spanish: Good

INTERESTS

- Yoga
- Hiking
- Volunteering as a job ambassador

TECHNICAL WRITER | EPAGES | Jan 2015 – Jan 2020

- Made the platform usable for developers, merchants, and customers, from API content to UI texts and help resources.
- Built a developer portal with engineering and product, and led developer experience and content strategy.
- Built and ran the localization process.
- Bridged engineering and product, and mentored young talent.
- Contributed to employer branding, blogging, and the tech community.

TECHNICAL WRITER | TCHIBO | Jul 2013 – Dec 2014

- Created product content for non-food products, in close exchange with quality and localization.

TECHNICAL WRITER | SUZLON WIND ENERGY | Oct 2007 – Jun 2013

- Enabled field engineers to transport, commission, and operate wind turbine generators with clear, step-by-step guidance.
- Made turbine software understandable for the people operating it.
- Built a shared terminology and coordinated translations into multiple languages.

TECHNICAL WRITER | TANNER AG | Apr 2006 – Sep 2007

- Technical communication projects across multiple industries.

EDUCATION

Graduate Technical Translator | University of Hildesheim | Dec 2005

TALKS & PUBLICATIONS *(selection)*

- betterCode() ArchDoc 2026: "If it's not documented, it doesn't exist"
- JavaLand 2025: "Das hätten wir dokumentieren sollen..."
- betterCode() API 2023: "Warum API Guidelines eine coole Sache sind"
- OTTO Tech Blog 2026: "Why AI hallucinates – and what technical writing can do about it"